

Milestone 7: Star Value Model

What one extra care-gap closure is worth through Star Ratings and QBP

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RESEARCH FRAMEWORK. Lift is research-generated or taken from published trials; no InComm lift, financial or issuance data is used. Dollar values are research ranges tagged by provenance.

1. Method

- Value of a closure = QBP dollars per enrollee x boundary density (rho) x pass-through / eligible share / gaps sharing the measure.
- rho is measured, not assumed: for every rated Medicare Advantage contract in CMS's public 2026 Star Ratings data, how likely is a small rate increase to cross a cut point and lift the overall rating over the 4-star QBP boundary.
- QBP per enrollee: KFF 2026, \$318 / \$381 / \$466. Eligible shares: public prevalence anchors (diabetes 0.20 / 0.26 / 0.32; hypertension 0.50 / 0.60 / 0.65).

2. Measured boundary density (CMS 2026, public)

Measure ID	Weight	N Contracts	Mean Rate	Rho Low	Rho Base	Rho High
C11	1	523	0.7778	0.0947	0.0982	0.1030
C12	3	523	0.8538	0.4523	0.4843	0.5049
C13	1	522	0.6178	0.0687	0.0759	0.0839
C14	3	508	0.7910	0.4355	0.4757	0.5159

3. Validation of the engine

- 524 contracts: the engine reproduces the published Part C summary within half a star for 98.1% and exactly for 78.1%.
- Not modelled: categorical adjustment index and reward factor (explains the small positive gap).
- 32.4% of MA contracts are rated 3.5 stars (the only ones one boundary crossing can lift to 4.0).

4. Which assumption matters most

Assumption	Provenance	Value At Low Input	Value At High Input	Swing Usd
eligible_share	Public source	131.4515	200.8712	69.4197

(diabetes / hypertension)	(CMS/KFF)			
qbp_per_enrollee_year	Public source (CMS/KFF)	131.1576	192.1995	61.0419
rho_boundary_density (CMS 2026 data)	Public data, computed (CMS 2026 Star Ratings)	146.3134	166.3828	20.0694

5. InComm metadata versus CMS 2026

InComm's StarsWeight differs from CMS's 2026 weight for eye exam and kidney screening, and COPD spirometry and BH follow-up feed no 2026 Part C measure. The model uses CMS's weights.

Caregapcode	Hedismeasureid	Starsweight	Cms Measure ID	Cms 2026 Weight	Note
BH_POST_DISCHARGE_7D	FUH-7	3	n/a	n/a	not a 2026 Part C Star measure
COPD_SPIROMETRY	SPR	1	n/a	n/a	not a 2026 Part C Star measure
DIAB_A1C_TEST	CDC-A1C	3	C12	3.0000	matches
DIAB_BLOOD_SUGAR	CDC-A1C	3	C12	3.0000	matches
DIAB_EYE_EXAM	CDC-EYE	3	C11	1.0000	InComm weight differs from CMS
DIAB_NEPHRO_SCREEN	KED	3	C13	1.0000	InComm weight differs from CMS
HTN_PCP_FOLLOWUP	CBP	3	C14	3.0000	matches